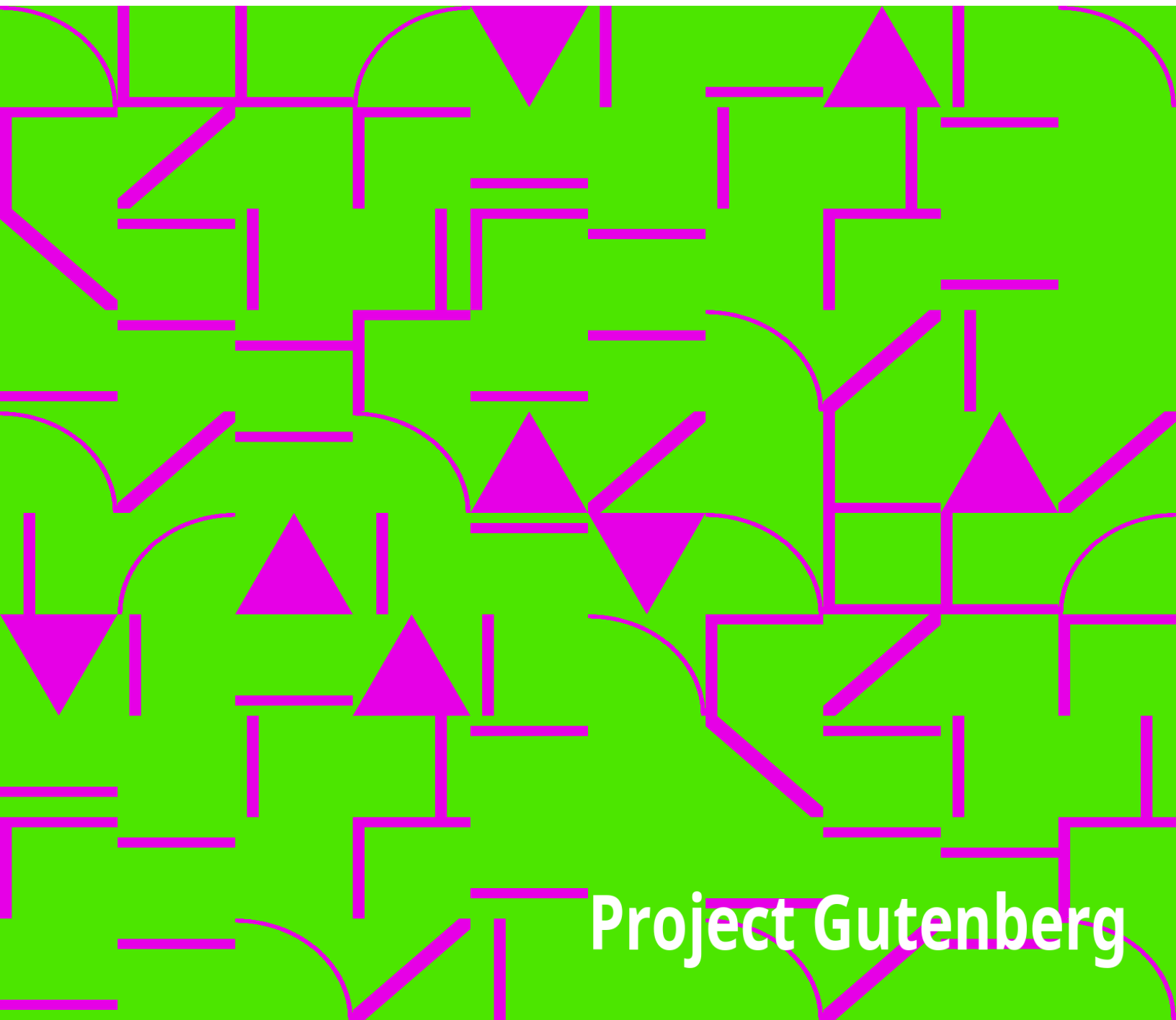


# Illustration of the Method of Recording Indian Languages

James Owen Dorsey et al.

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# Illustration of the Method of Recording Indian Languages

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Transcriber's note: The following notations are used to represent special characters:

[K] = turned (inverted) "K"  
[T] = turned "T"

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**SMITHSONIAN INSTITUTION—BUREAU OF ETHNOLOGY.**

**J.W. POWELL, DIRECTOR.**

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**ILLUSTRATION OF THE METHOD  
OF  
RECORDING INDIAN  
LANGUAGES.**

---

**FROM THE MANUSCRIPTS OF MESSRS. J.O. DORSEY, A.S.  
GATSCHET, AND S.R. RIGGS.**

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# HOW THE RABBIT CAUGHT THE SUN IN A TRAP.

AN OMAHA MYTH, OBTAINED FROM F. LAFLÈCHE BY J. OWEN DORSEY.

Egiŋe mactciñ'ge aká iŋa' ŋiñké ená-qtcí ŋigŋe júgigŋá -biamá.

It came rabbit the his the st. only dwelt with his they say.  
to pass sub. grandmother ob. own,

Kĩ ha'ega'ntcě' - qtcí -hna' `ábae ahí -biamá. Ha'ega'ntcě' -qtcí aŋá -bi

And morning very habitually hunting went they say. morning very went, they say  
thither say

ctěwa' níkaci'nga wí' sí snedě' -qti -hna' sígŋe aŋá-bitéamá. Kĩ íbaha' 3

notwith- person one foot long very as a rule trail had gone, they say. And to know  
standing him

ga'ŋá -biamá. Níaci'nga ŋi' ĩ'ta' wíta'ŋi' bŋé tá miñke, eŋéga' -biamá.

wished they say. Person the mv. ob. now I-first I go will I who, thought they say.

Ha'ega'ntcě' - páha' -bi ega' aŋá - Cĩ égiŋe níkaci'nga amá  
qtcí biamá.

Morning very arose they say having went they say. Again it person the mv.  
happened sub.

sígŋe aŋá - Égiŋe akí - Gá - ŋa'há, wíta'ŋi' bŋé 6  
bitéamá. biamá. biamá:

trail had they say. It came he they say. Said as they say: grand- I-first I go  
gone, to pass reached follows, mother

aŋídaxe ctěwa' níkaci'nga wí' a'aqai aŋaí te a'. [K]a'há, uŋí'a'ŋe

I make for in spite person one getting ahead of me he has gone. Grand- snare  
myself of it mother

dáxe tá minke, kĩ bŋíze tá miñke hă. Áta' ja' tada', á -biamá

I make it will I who, and I take him will I who . Why you do it should? said, they say

wa`újiŋga aka. Níaci'nga iŋát'abŋé hă, á- biamá. Kĩ mactciñ'ge aŋá- 9

old woman the sub. Person I hate him . said, they say. And rabbit went

biamá. Aŋá- bi ŋĩ cĩ sígŋe ŋétéamá. [K]ĩ ha' tě iŋápe ja' -biamá.

they say. Went they say when again trail had gone. And night the waiting for lay they say.

Man'dě -ŋa' ŋa' ukínacke gaxá- biamá, kĩ sígŋe ŋé -hna' tě ě'di iŋa'ŋa-

bow string the noose he they say, and trail went habitually the there he put it  
ob. made it

biamá. Égiŋe ha<sup>n</sup>+ega<sup>n</sup>- - uxía<sup>n</sup>ŋe ɕa<sup>n</sup> gila<sup>n</sup>'be ahí - Égiŋe 12  
tcě' qtcí biamá.

they say. It came morning very snare the to see arrived they say. It came  
to pass

mi<sup>n</sup>' ɕa<sup>n</sup> ɕizé akáma. Ta<sup>n</sup>'ɕi<sup>n</sup> -qtcí uɕá agɕá- biamá. [K]a<sup>n</sup>há ĭndáda<sup>n</sup>  
sun the cv. taken he had, Running very to tell went they say. Grandmother. what  
ob. they say. homeward,

éi<sup>n</sup>te bɕíze édega<sup>n</sup> a<sup>n</sup>'baaze -hna<sup>n</sup>' hă, á- biamá. [K]a<sup>n</sup>há, man'de- ɣa<sup>n</sup> ɕa<sup>n</sup>  
it I took but me it habitually . said they say. Grandmother, bow string the  
may scared ob.  
be

agɕíze ka<sup>n</sup>bdédega<sup>n</sup> a<sup>n</sup>'baaze -hna<sup>n</sup>'i hă, á- biamá. Máhi<sup>n</sup> aɕi<sup>n</sup>' -bi ega<sup>n</sup>' 15  
I took my I wished, but me it habitually . said they say. Knife had they having  
own scared say

ě'di aɕá- biamá. Kĩ eca<sup>n</sup>' -qtcí ahí- biamá. Píäjä ckáxe. Eáta<sup>n</sup> éga<sup>n</sup>  
there went, they say. And near very arrived they say. Bad you did. Why so  
ckáxe ä. Ě'di gí- ada<sup>n</sup>' i<sup>n</sup>ɕická-gă hă, á- biamá mi<sup>n</sup>' aká. Mactciñ'ge  
you did ? Hither come and for me untie it , said, they say sun the sub. Rabbit

aká ě'di aɕá- bi ctěwa<sup>n</sup> na<sup>n</sup>'pa -bi ega<sup>n</sup>' hébe íhe aɕé- hna<sup>n</sup>' - Kĩ 3  
biamá.

the there went they notwith- feared they having partly passed went habitually they And  
sub. say standing say by say.

ɣu`ě' aɕá- bi ega<sup>n</sup>' mása -biamá man'dě -ɣa<sup>n</sup> ɕa<sup>n</sup>'. Gañ'ki mi<sup>n</sup>' ɕa<sup>n</sup> ma<sup>n</sup>'-  
rushed went they having cut with they say bow string the And sun the cv. on  
say a knife ob. ob.

ciáha áíáɕa- biamá. Kĩ mactciñ'ge aká ábáɣu hi<sup>n</sup>' ɕa<sup>n</sup> názi- biamá  
high had they say. And Rabbit the space bet. the hair the burnt they  
gone, sub. shoulders ob. yellow say

ánakadá- bi ega<sup>n</sup>'. (Mactciñ'ge amá akí- biamá.) Ĭtcitci+, ɣa<sup>n</sup>há, 6  
it was hot they having. (Rabbit the mv. reached they say.) Itcitci+!! grandmother,  
on it say sub. home,

náɕiñgě- qti- ma<sup>n</sup>' hă, á- biamá. [T]úɕpaɕa<sup>n</sup>+, i<sup>n</sup>'naɕiñgě' -qti-ma<sup>n</sup>' eska<sup>n</sup>+,  
burnt to very I am — said, they say. Grandchild!! burnt to very I am I think,  
nothing nothing for me

á- biamá. Ceta<sup>n</sup>'.  
said, they say. So far.

## NOTES.

**581**, 1. Mactciñge, the Rabbit, or Siŋe-maka<sup>n</sup> (meaning uncertain), is the hero of numerous myths of several tribes. He is the deliverer of mankind from

different tyrants. One of his opponents is Ictinike, the maker of this world, according to the Iowas. The Rabbit's grandmother is Mother Earth, who calls mankind her children.

**581**, 7. a¢ai te a<sup>n</sup>. The conclusion of this sentence seems odd to the collector, but its translation given with this myth is that furnished by the Indian informant.

**581**, 12. ha<sup>n</sup>+ega<sup>n</sup>tcě-qtci, "ve—ry early in the morning." The prolongation of the first syllable adds to the force of the adverb "qtci," *very*.

**582**, 3. hebe ihe a¢e-hna<sup>n</sup>-biama. The Rabbit tried to obey the Sun; but each time that he attempted it, he was so much afraid of him that he passed by a little to one side. He could not go directly to him.

**582**, 4. 5. ma<sup>n</sup>ciaha aia¢a-biama. When the Rabbit rushed forward with bowed head, and cut the bow-string, the Sun's departure was so rapid that "he had *already* gone on high."

### ABBREVIATIONS USED IN THIS MYTH.

cv. curvilinear.  
mv. moving.  
st. sitting.  
sub. subject.  
ob. object.

### TRANSLATION.

Once upon a time the Rabbit dwelt in a lodge with no one but his grandmother. And it was his custom to go hunting very early in the morning. No matter how early in the morning he went, a person with very long feet had been along, leaving a trail. And he (the Rabbit), wished to know him. "Now," thought he, "I will go in advance of the person." Having arisen very early in the morning, he departed. Again it happened that the person had been along, leaving a trail. Then he (the Rabbit) went home. Said he, "Grandmother, though I arrange for myself to go first, a person anticipates me (every time). Grandmother, I will make a snare and catch him." "Why should you do it?" said she. "I hate the



person," he said. And the Rabbit departed. When he went, the foot-prints had been along again. And he lay waiting for night (to come). And he made a noose of a bow-string, putting it in the place where the foot-prints used to be seen. And he reached there very early in the morning for the purpose of looking at his trap. And it happened that he had caught the Sun. Running very fast, he went homeward to tell it. " Grandmother, I have caught something or other, but it scares me. Grandmother, I wished to take my bow-string, but I was scared every time," said he. He went thither with a knife. And he got very near it. "You have done wrong; why have you done so? Come hither and untie me," said the Sun. The Rabbit, although he went thither, was afraid, and kept on passing partly by him (or, continued going by a little to one side). And making a rush, with his head bent down (and his arm stretched out), he cut the bow-string with the knife. And the Sun had already gone on high. And the Rabbit had the hair between his shoulders scorched yellow, it having been hot upon him (as he stooped to cut the bow-string). (And the Rabbit arrived at home.) "Itciti+!! O grandmother, the heat has left nothing of me," said he. She said, "Oh! my grandchild! I think that the heat has left nothing of him for me." (From that time the rabbit has had a singed spot on his back, between the shoulders.)

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# DETAILS OF A CONJURER'S PRACTICE.

IN THE KLAMATH LAKE DIALECT. OBTAINED FROM MINNIE FROBEN, BY  
A.S. GATSCHET.

Máklaks shuákiuk kíuksash ká-i gú'l'hi húnkēlam lādshashtat, ndéna  
Indians in calling the conjurer not enter his into lodge, they halloo  
sha'hmóknok; kíush toks wán kiukáyank mú'luash m'na kaníta pî'sh.  
to call (him) out; the conjurer red fox hanging out on a pole as sign his outside "of him."  
Kukíaks tchú'tanish gátp'nank wigáta tchélyā mā'shipksh. Lútatkish 3  
Conjurers when treating approaching close by sit down the patient. The expounder  
wigáta kíukshēsh tcha'hlánshna. Shuyéga kíuks, wéwanuish  
close to the conjurer sits down. Starts choruses the conjurer, females  
tchīk winóta liukiámnank nadshā'shak tchútchtníshash. Hánshna  
then join in singing crowding around him simultaneously while he treats (the sick). He sucks  
mā'shish hú'nk hishuákshash, tátktish î'shkuk, hantchípka tcī'k  
diseased that man, the disease to extract, he sucks out then  
kukuága, wishinkága, mú'lkaga, káko gî'ntak, káhaktok nánuktua  
a small frog, small snake, small insect, bone afterwards, whatsoever anything  
nshendshkáne. Ts'ú'ks toks ké-usht tchékēle ítkal; lúlp toks mā'- 3  
small. A leg being fractured the (bad) blood he extracts; eyes but be-  
shisht tchékēlitat lgú'm shú'kēlank kī'tua lú'lpāt, kú'tash tchish  
ing sore into blood coal mixing he pours into the eyes, a louse too  
kshéwa lúlpāt pú'klash tuijámpgatk ltúixaktgi gíug.  
introduces into the eye the white of eye protruding for eating out.

## NOTES.

583, 1. shuákia does not mean to "*call on somebody*" generally, but only "*to call on the conjurer* or medicine man".

583, 2. wán stands for wánam nī'l: the fur or skin of a red or silver fox; kaníta pî'sh stands for kanítana látchash m'nálam: "outside of his lodge or cabin". The meaning of the sentence is: they raise their voices to call him out. Conjurers are in the habit of fastening a fox-skin outside of their lodges, as a business sign, and to let it dangle from a rod stuck out in an oblique direction.

583, 3. tchéłxa. During the treatment of a patient, who stays in a winter house, the lodge is often shut up at the top, and the people sit in a circle inside in utter darkness.

583, 5. liukiámnank. The women and all who take a part in the chorus usually sit in a circle around the conjurer and his assistant; the suffix -mna indicates close proximity. Nadshā'shak qualifies the verb winóta.

583, 5. tchútchtníshash. The distributive form of tchút't'na refers to each of the *various* manipulations performed by the conjurer on the patient.

584, 1. mā'shish, shortened from māshípkash, mā'shipksh, like k'lä'ksh from k'läkápkash.

584, 2. 3. There is a stylistic incongruity in using the distributive form, only in kukuàga (kúe, *frog*), káhaktok, and in nshendshkáne (nshekáni, npshékani, tsékani, tchékěni, *small*), while inserting the absolute form in wishinkága (wíshink, *garter-snake*) and in káko; mú'lkaga is more of a generic term and its distributive form is therefore not in use.

583, 2. káhaktok for ká-akt ak; ká-akt being the transposed distributive form kákat, of kát, which, what (pron. relat.).

584, 4. Igú'm. The application of remedial *drugs* is very unfrequent in this tribe; and this is one of the reasons why the term "conjurer" or "shaman" will prove to be a better name for the medicine man than that of "Indian doctor".

584, 4. kú'tash etc. The conjurer introduces a louse into the eye to make it eat up the protruding white portion of the sore eye.

**KÁLAK.**

# THE RELAPSE.

IN THE KLAMATH LAKE DIALECT BY DAVE HILL. OBTAINED BY A.S.  
GATSCHET.

Hä náyäns hissúáksas mā'shitk kálak, tsúi kíuks nā'-ulakta tchu-  
When another man fell sick as relapsed, then the conjurer concludes to  
tánuapkuk. Tchúi tchúta; tchúi yá-uks huk shlää kálak a gēk. Tchi  
treat (him). And he treats; and remedy this finds out (that) relapsed he. Thus  
huk shuī'sh sápa. Tsúi nā'sh shuī'sh sáyuaks hú'mtcha kálak, tchúi 3  
the song- indicates. And one song- having (that) of the kind then  
remedy remedy found out of relapsed (he is),  
nánuk húk shuī'sh tpä'wa hú'nksht kaltchitchíkshash heshuampělítki  
all those remedies indicate (that) him the spider (-remedy) would  
gíug. Tchúi hú'k káltchitchiks yá-uka; ubá-us húk káltchitchiksam  
cure. Then the spider treats him; a piece of deer-skin of the spider  
tchutēnō'tkish. Tsúi húkantka ubá-ustka tchutá; tātáktak huk 6  
(is) the curing-tool. Then by means deer-skin he treats just the size that  
of that (him); of the spot  
kálak mā'sha, gā'tak ubá-ush ktú'shka tā'tak huk mā'sha. Tsúi húk  
relapse is infected, so much of deer-skin he cuts out as where he is suffering. Then  
káltchitchiks siunóta nā'dsḡank hú'nk ubá-nsh. Tchú'yuk p'laíta  
the "spider" song is started while applying that skin piece. And he over it  
nétatka skútash, tsúi sha hú'nk udú'pka hānā'shishtka, tsúi hú'k 9  
he stretches a blanket, and they it strike with conjurer's arrows, then it  
gutā'ga tsulā'kshtat; gā'tsa lú'pí kiatéga, tsúi tsulē'ks k'lāká, tchúi  
enters into the body; a particle firstly enters, then (it) body becomes, and  
at pushpúshuk shlē'sh húk ubá-ush. Tsúi mā'ns tánkēni ak waítash  
now dark it to look at that skin-piece. Then after a while after so and so many days  
hú'k púshpúshli at mā'ns=gîtk tsulā'ks=sitk shlā'sh. Tsí ní sáyuakta; 12  
that black (thing) at last (is) flesh-like to look at. Thus I am informed;  
túmi hú'nk sháyuakta hú'masht=gîsht tchutī'sht; tsúyuk tsúshni  
many men know (that) in this manner were effected cures; and he then always  
wā'mpēle.  
was well again.

## NOTES.

**585**, 1. náyäns hissuáksas: another man than the conjurers of the tribe. The objective case shows that mā'shitk has to be regarded here as the participle of an impersonal verb: mā'sha núsh, and mā'sha nú, it ails me, I am sick.

**585**, 2. yá-uks is remedy in general, spiritual as well as material. Here a tamánuash song is meant by it, which, when sung by the conjurer, will furnish him the certainty if his patient is a relapse or not. There are several of these medicine-songs, but all of them (nánuk hú'k shuí'sh) when consulted point out the spider-medicine as the one to apply in this case. The spider's curing-instrument is that small piece of buckskin (ubá-ush) which has to be inserted under the patient's skin. It is called the spider's medicine because the spider-song is sung during its application.

**585**, 10. gutä'ga. The whole operation is concealed from the eyes of spectators by a skin or blanket stretched over the patient and the hands of the operator.

**585**, 10. kiatéga. The buckskin piece has an oblong or longitudinal shape in most instances, and it is passed under the skin sideways and very gradually.

**585**, 11. tánkěni ak waítash. Dave Hill gave as an approximate limit five days' time.

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# SWEAT-LODGES.

IN THE KLAMATH LAKE DIALECT BY MINNIE FROBEN. OBTAINED BY  
A.S. GATSCHET.

É-ukshkni lápa spú'klis̄h gítko. Kúkiuk kělekapkash spú'klis̄hla  
The lake two sweat-lodges have. To weep over the deceased they build  
people (kinds of) sweat-lodges

yépank kăila; stutílantko spú'klis̄h, kăila waltchátko. Spú'klis̄h a  
digging up the ground; are roofed (these) with covered. (Another)  
sweat-lodges earth sweat-lodge

sha shú'ta kué-utch, kítchikan'sh stinága=shítko; skú'tash a wáldsha 3  
they build of willows, a little cabin looking like; blankets they spread

spú'klis̄htat tataták sě spukliá. Tátataks a hú'nk wéas lúla, tatátaks  
over the sweating-lodge when in it they sweat. Whenever children died, or when

a tchíměna, snáwedsh wénuitk, kú'ki kělekátko, spú'klitcha  
híshuaksh  
a husband became (or) the wife (is) they for cause of go sweating  
widower, widowed, weep death

túmi shashámoks= lólatko; túnepni waítash tchík sa hú'uk spú'klia. 6  
many relatives who have lost five days then they sweat.

Shiúlakiank sha ktái húyuka skoilakuápkuk; hútoks ktái ká-i  
a tatá  
Gathering they stones (they) heat to heap them up (after those stones never  
(them) use);

spukliú't'huīsh. Spúklis̄h lúpġa húyuka; kělpka a át, ílhiat átui,  
having been used Sweat lodge in front of they heat heated when, they bring at  
for sweating. (them); (being) (them) inside once,

kídshna ai î ámbu, kliulála. Spú'kli a sha túměni "hours"; kělpkuk 9  
pour on them water, sprinkle. Sweat then several hours; being quite  
they warmed up

géka shualkóltchuk péniak kō'ks pépe-udshak éwagatat, kóketat, é-ush  
they (and) to cool without dress only to go in a spring, river, lake  
leave themselves off bathing

wigáta. Spukli-uápka mā'ntch. Shpótuok i-akéwa kápka, skú'tawia  
close by. They will sweat for long To make themselves they bend young (they) tie  
hours. strong down pine-trees together

sha wéwakag knú'kstga. Ndshiétchatka knú'ks a sha shúshata. 12

they small brushwood with ropes. Of (willow-)bark the ropes they make.

Gátpampělank shkoshkî'l̥xa ktáktiag hú'shkankok kělekápkash, ktá-i  
On going home they heap up into cairns small stones in remembrance of the dead, stones  
shúshuankaptcha î'hiank.  
of equal size selecting.

## NOTES.

No Klamath or Modoc sweat-lodge can be properly called a *sweat-house*, as is the custom throughout the West. One kind of these lodges, intended for the use of mourners only, are solid structures, almost underground; three of them are now in existence, all believed to be the gift of the principal national deity. Sudatories of the other kind are found near every Indian lodge, and consist of a few willow-rods stuck into the ground, both ends being bent over. The process gone through while sweating is the same in both kinds of lodges, with the only difference as to time. The ceremonies mentioned 4-13. all refer to sweating in the mourners' sweat-lodges. The sudatories of the Oregonians have no analogy with the *estufas* of the Pueblo Indians of New Mexico, as far as their construction is concerned.

**586**, 1. lápa spú'kl̥ish, two sweat-lodges, stands for two *kinds* of sweat-lodges.

**586**, 5. shashámoks=lólatko forms *one* compound word: one who, or: those who have lost relatives by death; cf. ptísh=lúlsh, pgísh=lúlsh; hishuákga ptísh=lúlatk, male orphan whose father has died. In the same manner, kělekátko stands here as a participle referring simultaneously to híshuaksh and to snáwedsh wénuitk, and can be rendered by "*bereaved*". Shashámoks, distr. form of shá-amoks, is often pronounced sheshámaks. Túmi etc. means, that many others accompany to the sweat-lodge, into which about six persons can crowd themselves, bereaved husbands, wives or parents, because the deceased were related to them.

**586**, 7. Shiúlakiank etc. For developing steam the natives collect only such stones for heating as are neither too large nor too small; a medium size seeming most appropriate for concentrating the largest amount of heat. The old sweat-lodges are surrounded with large accumulations of stones which, to judge from their blackened exterior, have served the purpose of generating steam; they weigh not over 3 to 5 pounds in the average, and in the vicinity travelers discover many small cairns, not over four feet high, and others lying



in ruins. The shrubbery around the sudatory is in many localities tied up with willow wisps and ropes.

**586**, 11. Spukli-uápka mā'ntch means that the sweating-process is repeated many times during the five days of observance; they sweat at least twice a day.

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# A DOG'S REVENGE.

A DAKOTA FABLE, BY MICHEL RENVILLE. OBTAINED BY REV. S.R.  
RIGGS.

Šun̄ka waŋ; ƙa wakaŋka waŋ waŋiŋ waŋ taŋka hnaka. Uŋkan  
Dog a; and old-woman a pack a large laid away. And  
šun̄ka ƙoŋ he sdonya. Uŋkaŋ waŋna haŋyetu, uŋkaŋ wakaŋka  
dog the that knew. And now night, and old-woman  
išt̄inman kečiŋ ƙa en ya: tuka wakaŋka kiŋ sdonkiye ƙa kiktahaŋ 3  
asleep he thought and there went: but old woman the knew and awake  
waŋke, ƙa ite hdakiŋyaŋ ape ƙa kićakse, ƙa nina po, keyapi.  
lay, and face across struck and gashed, and much swelled, they say.  
Uŋkaŋ haŋhaŋna hehaŋ šun̄ka tokeća waŋ en hi, ƙa okiya ya.  
And morning then dog another a there came, and to-talk-with went.  
Tuka pamahdedaŋ ite mahen inina yaŋka. Uŋkaŋ taku ićante nišića  
But head-down face within silent was. And what of-heart you-bad  
heciŋhaŋ omakiyaka wo, eya. Uŋkaŋ, Inina yaŋka wo, wakaŋka 3  
if me-tell, he-said. And, still be-you, old-woman  
waŋ tehiya omakihaŋ do, eya, keyapi. Uŋkaŋ, Token̄ nićihaŋ he, eya.  
a hardly me-dealt-with, he-said, they say. And, How to-thee-did-she, he-said.  
Uŋkaŋ, Waŋin waŋ taŋka hnaka e waŋmdake ƙa heoŋ ota awape:  
And, Pack a large she-laid-away I-saw and therefore to-go-for I waited:  
ƙa waŋna haŋ tehaŋ kehan, išt̄inbe seća e en mde ƙa pa timaheŋ 6  
and now night far then, she-asleep probably there I went and head house-in  
yewaya, uŋkaŋ kiktahaŋ waŋke šta hećamoŋ: ƙa, Ši, de tukten  
I-poked, and awake lay although this-I-did: and, shoo, this where  
yau he, eye, ƙa itohna amape, ƙa dećen iyemayaŋ ce, eye ƙa kipazo.  
you-come, she- and face-on smote- and thus she-me-left he-said and showed-  
said, me, him.  
Uŋkaŋ, Huŋhuŋhe! tehiya ećanićoŋ do, ihomeća waŋiŋ kiŋ uŋtapi 9  
And, Alas! alas! hardly she-did-to-you, therefore pack the we-eat  
kta ce, eye ƙa, Mnićiya wo, eya, keyapi. Ito, Minibozaŋna kićo wo,  
will, he-said and, Assemble, he-said, they say. Now, Water-mist call,  
ka, Yaksa taŋiŋ šni kico wo, Tahu waśaka kico wo, ƙa, Taisaŋpena  
and Bite off not manifest call, Neck strong invite, and, His-knife-sharp

kico wo, eya, keyapi. Uṅkaṅ owasiṅ wićakićo: ға waṅna owasiṅ en 12  
 call, he-said, they-say. And all them-he-called: and now all there  
 hipi hehaṅ heya, keyapi: Ihopo, wakaṅka de tehiya ećakićoṅ će;  
 came then this-he-said, they-say: Come-on, old-woman this hardly dealt-with;  
 miniheićiyapo, haṅyetu hepiya waćonića wakiṅ waṅ tehiṅda ға on  
 bestir-yourselves, night during dried-meat pack a she-forbid and for  
 tehiya ećakićoṅ tuka, ehaeś untapi kta će, eya, keyapi. 15  
 hardly dealt-with-him but, indeed we eat will he-said, they say.  
 Uṅkaṅ Minibozanṅa ećiyapi ҡoṅ he waṅna maḡaźukiye ća, aṅpetu  
 Then Water-mist called the that now rain-made, and, day  
 ośaṅ maḡaźu ećen otpaza; ға wakeya owasiṅ nina spaya, wihutipaspe  
 all-through rained until dark; and tent all very wet, tent-pin  
 olidoka owasiṅ taṅyaṅ ḥpan. Uṅkaṅ hehaṅ Yaksa taṅiṅ śni wihuti- 18  
 holes all well soaked. And then Bite-off-manifest-not tent-fast-  
 paspe kiṅ owasiṅ yakse, tuka taṅiṅ śni yaṅ yakse nakaeś wakaṅka  
 enings the all bit-off, but slyly bit-off so that old-woman  
 kiṅ sdonkiye śni. Uṅkaṅ Tahuwaśaka he waṅiṅ ҡoṅ yape ća maniṅ-  
 the knew not. And Neck-strong he pack the seized, and away  
 kiya yapa iyeya, ға tehaṅ ehpeya. Hećen Taisaṅpena waṅiṅ ҡoṅ 21  
 off holding-in- and far threw-it. So His-knife- pack the  
 mouth-carried, sharp  
 ćokaya kiyaksa-iyeya. Hećen waṅiṅ ҡoṅ haṅyetu hepiyana temya-  
 in-middle tore-it-open. Hence pack the night during they-ate-  
 iyeyapi, keyapi.  
 all-up, they say.  
 Hećen tuwe wamanoṅ keś, saṅpa iwahaṅićida wamanoṅ waṅ hduze, 24  
 So that who steals although, more haughty thief a marries,  
 eyapi eće; de huṅkakaṅpi do.  
 they-say always; this they-fable.

## NOTES.

**588**, 24. This word "hduze" means *to take* or *hold one's own*; and is most commonly applied to a man's taking a wife, or a woman a husband. Here it may mean either that one who starts in a wicked course consorts with others "more wicked than himself," or that he himself grows in the bad and takes hold of the greater forms of evil—*marries* himself to the wicked one.

It will be noted from this specimen of Dakota that there are some particles in the language which cannot be represented in a translation. The "do" used at the end of phrases or sentences is only for emphasis and to round up a period. It belongs mainly to the language of young men. "Wo" and "po" are the signs of the imperative.

## TRANSLATION.

There was a dog; and there was an old woman who had a pack of dried meat laid away. This the dog knew; and, when he supposed the old woman was asleep, he went there at night. But the old woman was aware of his coming and so kept watch, and, as the dog thrust his head under the tent, she struck him across the face and made a great gash, which swelled greatly.

The next morning a companion dog came and attempted to talk with him. But the dog was sullen and silent. The visitor said: "Tell me what makes you so heart-sick." To which he replied: "Be still, an old woman has treated me badly." "What did she do to you?" He answered: "An old woman had a pack of dried meat; this I saw and went for it; and when it was now far in the night, and I supposed she was asleep, I went there and poked my head under the tent. But she was lying awake and cried out: 'Shoo! what are you doing here?' and struck me on the head and wounded me as you see."

Whereupon the other dog said: "Alas! Alas! she has treated you badly, verily we will eat up her pack of meat. Call an assembly: call *Water-mist* (i.e., rain); call *Bite-off-silently*; call *Strong-neck*; call *Sharp-knife*." So he invited them all. And when they had all arrived, he said: "Come on! an old woman has treated this friend badly; bestir yourselves; before the night is past, the pack of dried meat which she prizes so much, and on account of which she has thus dealt with our friend, that we will eat all up".

Then the one who is called *Rain-mist* caused it to rain, and it rained all the day through until dark; and the tent was all drenched, and the holes of the tent-pins were thoroughly softened. Then *Bite-off-silently* bit off all the lower tent-fastenings, but he did it so quietly that the old woman knew nothing of it. Then *Strong-neck* came and seized the pack with his mouth, and carried it far away. Whereupon *Sharp-knife* came and ripped the pack through the middle; and so, while it was yet night, they ate up the old woman's pack of dried meat.

*Moral.*—A common thief becomes worse and worse by attaching himself to more daring companions. This is the myth.

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